

Gabriela Penarska

Product Designer

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Skills

Design

End-to-end product design
Interaction design
Prototyping
Design systems
UI design
Visual design
Accessibility (WCAG)
Usability testing
User research
Human-centered design
Information architecture
Wireframing
Data-driven insights
Human-computer interaction
Data visualization
Agentic AI

Tools

Figma
ProtoPie
Framer
Miro
Notion
Adobe CC

AI tools

Figma Make
Claude Design
Google Stitch
Claude Code
Codex

Development

HTML
CSS
Python

Honours

DTU Green Challenge

Developed a mobile app (Android) to reduce food waste, selected to present in front of investors

Interaction 2024, Tokyo

AI-copilot storytelling for children, conference paper selected

DTU Finalist X-Tech Entrepreneurship

AI-driven startup, awarded one week of workshops in Silicon Valley (Nvidia, Plug & Play offices), UC Berkeley and Stanford

Interests

Photography
Travel filmmaking
Solo backpacking

Product Designer with **5 years** of experience owning product design end-to-end across desktop, web and HMI interfaces, from ambiguous problem to shipped products with business impact. I bring clarity to complex technical domains by framing the problem with product owners and engineers before the pixels, backing decisions with research, and designing with the system rather than around it. I pay close attention to visual and interaction detail, accessibility, and the technical realities of what I design.

Experience

UX Designer | Nacos Marine (formerly Wärtsilä)

Jan 2023 – Dec 2025 · Copenhagen

- Led and shipped end-to-end UX design and product strategy for new vessel monitoring interfaces across web, desktop and HMI, designing to each platform's constraints while holding one recognisable product identity, and translating complex technical requirements into intuitive and accessible systems that build user trust under high pressure. Delivered to **13 000+ ships** globally, supporting **30k+ daily active users**.
- Cut time-to-task execution by **70%** by transforming high-volume data into high-impact dashboards and monitoring panels handling **70+ active data points** per single page.
- Reduced development uncertainty by surfacing assumptions early rather than delivering the brief as written: led discovery interviews and usability testing across enterprise and consumer products, and facilitated iterative co-creation workshops and design reviews that aligned stakeholders on problem framing and solution direction.
- Increased engineer productivity and scoped down long manuals by growing design systems and architecting user-centric (HCI) workflow improvements across the legacy interfaces.
- Lowered time-to-critical decision and cognitive load by collaborating cross-functionally with product owners, engineers and developers from different countries to define customer needs and product strategy.
- Won repeat business, a customer ordering a second interface after a successful release, by designing novel end-to-end patterns for vessel navigation that held the brand identity and presenting the work directly to major customers.

UX/UI Designer | Cytiva

May 2021 – Jan 2023 · Krakow

- Cut daily task-completion time by **30%** for **500+ employees** by leading the redesign of the internal hour-tracking system.
- Designed, co-developed and delivered an end-to-end new desktop customer-ordering tool.
- Helped maintain a design system.
- Simplified equipment ordering for sourcing specialists by redesigning procurement data dashboards, informed by qualitative user research.
- Partnered with business analysts, developers and project managers, co-designed the company's internal employee website and presented work to customers.

Education

MSc Human-Centered Artificial Intelligence | Technical University of Denmark

Aug 2022 – Mar 2025

Human-centered design, accessibility, interaction design, data visualization, ML foundations. Thesis: a dashboard using data from a wearable button to improve treatment for patients with mental health disorders.

MEng Applied Computer Science | AGH University of Science and Technology

Feb 2021 – Aug 2022

Software engineering, HCI, front-end development. Thesis: ticket platform redesign for **1000+ students**.

Member of BEST AGH Krakow. Coordinated the design team for a Europe-wide conference of **400+ attendees** and grew local recruitment applicants by **15%**.

Exchange student | University of Tokyo · NOVA University of Lisbon

2023/2024 · 2022

HCI, sense of agency.